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General Comment

AI "artwork" is garbage.

As a sequential artist, I often look for inspiration from other artists, and will seek out more of an artist's work if I see one piece of theirs that I like.

The nature of AI "artwork" is irreproducible -- asking for AI to generate an image from the same prompt nine times produces nine dramatically different pieces, all of different styles, characters, and settings. It is impossible to get AI to produce slight variations of pieces or draw the same character in a new way (see also: the children's book "Alice and Sparkle"), and more importantly, there is no body of similar artwork to view from any given image you might want to see more of.

The end result is that, from a standpoint of inspiration, AI "artwork" is the creative equivalent of a condom: a dead end with nowhere to go. There is no artist to hire or conversation to be had. There is no body of artwork to browse. There is nothing to follow up with.

The only people who want to replace humans with AI are those who have no intention of supporting human jobs to begin with. The number of companies who see AI as an alternative for those pesky humans with their civil liberties and demands for a living wage is too many to count.

Also, many artists I know are unwilling to work for people with offensive political views they find morally reprehensible; those individuals are especially empowered by AI that will create their political propaganda without any pushback or disagreement whatsoever. This allows offensive content to spread further than it would have if a human employee or contractor had simply refused to draw such things. It also reduces the ability for human workers to use such threats of refusal as leverage, if an AI can produce a "good enough" replacement. AI is the metaphorical scab crossing the picket line, and does so at a price no human could ever compete with.

I have friends who have worked as "quality control" contractors for AI companies like Outlier, which offers what is best described as a series of glorified mechanical Turks. Despite the "booming" AI market, there is often not enough work to go around even there, as companies discover the shortcomings of these AI offerings and contracts dry up.

Put simply: the output of AI is terrible, it empowers terrible people with terrible opinions to interfere with democracy, and the job market is made worse by companies who don't care how terrible the output is, so long as it's cheaper than a pesky human that might dare to disagree. Unless and until you can fix those problems, AI is simply not worth it.